PUGET SOUND ENERGY • PROCEDURE

Critical Fire Weather Operations Procedure

Document Number	PSE-WRM-001	**Revision**	03
Effective Date	08-19-2026	**Owner**	Wildfire Risk Management

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1 Purpose

This procedure establishes the operational requirements for **Puget Sound Energy** (**PSE**) to reduce the likelihood of wildfire ignitions caused by PSE's electrical equipment. Additionally, this procedure provides protocols for the following:

- Situational awareness
- Rapid and safe response during Critical Fire Weather
- Wildfire threat identification
- Real-time analysis
- Operational response to reduce equipment-related ignition risks

PSE declares its internal Wildfire Season annually (see *PSE Wildfire Season Declaration Procedure*). This procedure applies year-round when high fire threat conditions exist, including outside the declared PSE Wildfire Season.

2 Scope

This procedure governs PSE's operational framework during elevated or Critical Fire Weather conditions. It establishes requirements for situational awareness, cross-functional coordination, and risk-mitigation actions to minimize wildfire ignition and system impact.

The scope encompasses all phases of wildfire management, including:

- **Preparedness:** Routine monitoring and heightened readiness activities
- **Response:** Operational execution during Critical Fire Weather conditions
- **Recovery:** System restoration and post-event activities

This procedure applies to all relevant PSE business units — including System Operations, Load Office, **Wildfire Risk Management** (**WRM**), and **Emergency Management & Resiliency** (EMR) — as well as supporting corporate functions and external partners. It ensures organizational alignment with safety, reliability, and regulatory standards while prioritizing customer needs.

3 Terms & Acronyms

3.1 Defined Acronyms

Table 1: Defined Acronyms

Acronym	Full Term	Definition
3Ø	Three-Phase	Refers to a three-phase electrical circuit configuration. Used in the context of the feeder-level three-phase getaway switch during PSPS step restoration.

Acronym	Full Term	Definition
ADMS	Advanced Distribution Management System	PSE's primary distribution operations platform used to enable Storm Mode, establish and track fire-danger incidents, log EPS activation, and manage distribution circuit and substation status during elevated fire weather events.
CAC	Customer Access Center	The PSE customer contact center responsible for handling customer inquiries, outage reports, service requests, and communications related to electric and gas services, including support during planned outages and emergency events.
CIO	Community Incident Outreach	A community engagement action activated during Level 3 or higher, as determined by the Communications Lead and PIO, to support communities affected by a PSPS event.
CRC	Community Resource Center	A physical resource location (e.g., FireDawg) activated to support customers impacted by a PSPS de-energization event.
CWICC	Central Washington Interagency Communication Center	The interagency dispatch center notified by the System Operations Supervisor or Transmission Supervisor when a fault occurs under EPS – Level 2 settings in Eastern Washington, per PSE's MOU with DNR.
DNO	Do Not Operate	A field tag applied to isolation devices during PSPS de-energization to prevent inadvertent equipment operation.
DNR	Department of Natural Resources	Washington State agency responsible for wildfire protection and outdoor burning regulation on state and private forested lands.
ECC	Emergency Coordination Center	PSE's centralized coordination center staffed by the Incident Management Team (IMT) to manage PSPS planning, execution, communications, and restoration.
EFR	Electric First Response	PSE's electric field response personnel, including Troublemen, who perform patrols, respond to faults, and support de-energization and restoration during elevated Critical Fire Weather events.
EMD	Emergency Management Division	The Washington State Emergency Management Division.
EMR	Emergency Management & Resiliency	PSE internal department responsible for emergency management coordination.
EPS	Enhanced Powerline Settings	Protective operational settings applied to distribution circuit breakers and line reclosers during elevated fire weather conditions, including disabling reclosing and enabling instantaneous trip.
ERC	Energy Release Component	A fire weather index reflecting the available energy per unit area in flammable material.
ETR	Estimated Time of Restoration	The projected date and time when power is expected to be restored to customers following an outage or PSPS de-energization event.

Acronym	Full Term	Definition
FBI	Fire Behavior Index	A numerical index used to assess and predict fire behavior across various fuel types, aiding in operational fire management and decision-making.
FDSO	Fire Danger System Operator	A specially assigned System Operator (level 5 or higher) staffed 24/7 during Operational Levels 2–4.
FPIC	Fire Potential Index Composite	A metric used to assess fire potential by combining two key components: the fire potential index and the ignition component, to support operational decision-making.
FSP	Fire Size Potential	A Technosylva FireRisk metric representing the potential acreage a fire could reach within 8 hours if initial attack is unsuccessful.
GFR	Gas First Response	PSE's gas first response personnel trained and authorized to respond to natural gas incidents, assess hazards, and take immediate actions to protect public safety, property, and the gas system.
GIS	Geographic Information Systems	A spatial data and mapping system. Referenced in the Director of Engineering & GIS role and as a GIS Support IMT position staffed during Levels 3 and 4 ECC activation.
HFT	High Fire Threat	A PSE designation assigned to distribution circuits and transmission lines with elevated fire threat rankings based on historical weather patterns, fuel conditions, and fuel loading.
IAP	Incident Action Plan	The formal planning document developed by the Planning Section during a Level 3 or 4 event. Documents fire analysis, de-energization plans, customer impacts, communication timelines, and operational decisions.
IMT	Incident Management Team	The team staffed within the ECC to manage PSPS operations under the Incident Command System. Includes the PSPS ECC Director, Operations Section Chief, Planning Section Chief, Logistics Section Chief, PIO, and other functional positions.
iTOA	Integrated Transmission Operations Application	PSE's transmission operations logging platform used to log all transmission switching actions, including reclosing status, de-energization, and restoration activities.
MFT	Moderate Fire Threat	A PSE designation assigned to distribution circuits with a Technosylva HFT Index score greater than 0.4 and less than or equal to 0.475.
MLM	Municipal Liaison Manager	PSE personnel responsible for coordinating with municipal and government stakeholders during PSPS events, including partner briefings and restoration communications.
MOU	Memorandum of Understanding	A formal agreement between PSE and the Washington State DNR applicable to Eastern Washington. Requires PSE to notify CWICC when a fault occurs under EPS – Level 2 settings for both the distribution and transmission systems.

Acronym	Full Term	Definition
NWS	National Weather Service	The federal agency that issues official fire weather forecasts, Fire Weather Watches, and Red Flag Warnings. PSE's primary source for official weather advisories and spot forecasts.
OAR	Operational Action Recommendation	A structured document completed by the System Operations Supervisor in collaboration with Load Office, Meteorologist, and WLMs before each Operations Planning Call. Consolidates current weather conditions, asset status, and the recommended escalation or de-escalation action.
PIO	Public Information Officer	The IMT position responsible for drafting and coordinating all internal and external messaging during a PSPS event, including the Notification Plan, PSPS Watch/Warning/Imminent messages, and customer notifications.
PoF	Probability of Failure	A Technosylva FireRisk metric representing the daily probability of a wind-related outage on a circuit.
PSE	Puget Sound Energy	The regulated electric, gas, and generation utility that owns and operates the systems governed by this procedure.
PSPS	Public Safety Power Shutoff	A planned, controlled de-energization of identified transmission and/or distribution circuits during Critical Fire Weather conditions to reduce the risk of wildfire ignition caused by PSE's electrical equipment.
ROS	Rate of Spread	The forward speed of a fire perimeter, expressed as a distance per unit time.
SCADA	Supervisory Control and Data Acquisition	A control system used to remotely monitor and control electrical system equipment.
SME	Subject Matter Expert	An individual with specialized knowledge relevant to a given task or process.
TNS	Targeted Notification Specialist	A PSE role responsible for managing targeted customer notifications during PSPS events, operating under direction of the Operations Section Chief.
TO	Transmission Operator	Load Office personnel assigned to manage transmission switching operations during PSPS de-energization and restoration, including logging all actions in iTOA and directing Patrol Teams.
UDS	Unified Division Supervisor	PSE Field Operations Supervisor responsible for regional storm base coordination, crew management, damage reporting, and restoration oversight during PSPS events.
UTC	Utilities and Transportation Commission	The Washington State regulatory body that oversees PSE's utility operations.
WLM	Wildfire Liaison Manager	PSE personnel who monitor wildfire indicators, maintain external agency coordination, and provide situational intelligence and subject-matter support to operational decision-making.

Acronym	Full Term	Definition
WRF	Weather Research and Forecasting	A numerical weather prediction model used by Technosylva FireRisk for historical re-analysis (20-year dataset) and daily operational weather data to support fire risk calculations.
WRM	Wildfire Risk Management	The PSE business unit that is responsible for wildfire risk monitoring, analysis, and coordination of wildfire mitigation programs across PSE's service territory.
WWG	Western Weather Group	A third-party meteorological firm contracted by PSE to provide supplemental utility-oriented fire weather forecast products and backup meteorological services.

3.2 Defined Terms

Table 2: Defined Terms

Term	Definition
All Clear	The declaration that fire weather conditions have sufficiently abated to support a return to Routine Operations – Level 1. Triggers de-escalation of EPS settings, FDSO release, and stakeholder notifications.
Critical Fire Weather	Atmospheric conditions – including combinations of low relative humidity, elevated wind speeds, dry fuels, and high fire potential indices – that significantly increase the risk of wildfire.
De-energization	The process of removing electrical energy from equipment, systems, or circuits, so that it is no longer energized. Done for safety, maintenance, repair, or emergency purposes.
Fire Threat Score	A numerical value ranging from 0 to 1 assigned to each PSE distribution circuit and transmission line based on the annual HFT analysis.
Fire Weather Watch	An official NWS product indicating that conditions are favorable for the development of Critical Fire Weather within the next 12–72 hours.
FireDawg	PSE's mobile CRC deployment, providing resources and support to customers impacted by a PSPS de-energization event.
Go/No-Go Decision	The official decision point at PSPS – Level 3 at which the Planning Section Chief initiates a call with the Vice President of Gas & Electric Operations and the Senior Vice President of Energy Operations to determine whether to proceed to PSPS – Level 4 de-energization (Go) or de-escalate (No-Go).
Operational Level	PSE's internal fire weather response classification system, ranging from Level 1 (Routine Operations) to Level 4 (Initiate PSPS). Each level has defined weather triggers, required operational actions, and designated approval authorities.
Operations Planning Call	A structured coordination call convened by the System Operations Supervisor prior to any escalation or de-escalation decision. The completed OAR is presented during the call to support the escalation recommendation and approval decision.

Term	Definition
Pacific Northwest 7-Day Significant Fire Potential	A regional outlook product providing a 7-day assessment of expected fire activity and large fire potential across the Pacific Northwest, categorized into four risk levels.
PSE Wildfire Season	The period of elevated fire weather risk annually declared by PSE when conditions and vegetation moisture levels create elevated wildfire risk, requiring enhanced operational mitigations.
Re-energization	The process of restoring electrical energy back to equipment, systems, or circuits after de-energization.
Reclosing	An automatic protective function on transmission and distribution lines that attempts to restore power following a fault.
Red Flag Conditions	A combination of dry fuels and Critical Fire Weather, such as low relative humidity and strong winds, that significantly increases the potential for rapid wildfire ignition, spread, and extreme fire behavior.
Red Flag Warning	An official NWS product indicating that Critical Fire Weather conditions are occurring or imminent, based on a combination of low relative humidity, strong winds, and dry fuels.
Restoration	A sequenced process for restoring power to de-energized circuits or lines following a PSPS. Proceeds from the substation circuit breaker through getaway isolation and feeder isolation devices sequentially, with each section confirmed clear before the next is energized.
Routine Operations	The baseline operational state, designated as Level 1, during which no Critical Fire Weather indicators are present and standard monitoring continues.
Situation Report	A standardized operational update issued by the ECC IMT every 12 hours during an active PSPS event. Used to communicate current conditions, operational status, and restoration timelines to internal stakeholders, partner agencies, and customers.
Storm Mode	A configuration applied in ADMS to distribution circuits and substations designated for EPS action. Enabled by the System Operations Supervisor up to one hour before EPS initiation.
Wind Advisory	An NWS product issued when sustained winds or gusts are expected to reach levels that may pose a risk to life and property. Considered among the elevated Critical Fire Weather conditions that may trigger Level 1 awareness actions and initiation of the OAR process.
WRM Priority Circuits	Distribution circuits designated for elevated operational mitigation during Critical Fire Weather, comprising High Fire Threat (HFT) and Moderate Fire Threat (MFT) circuits. Not all Priority Circuits are EPS-capable; non-EPS-capable Priority Circuits are addressed through block reclosing and/or the hot line work switch.

4 Roles & Responsibilities

The specific roles and responsibilities of critical functions in the decision process are identified in the RACI Matrix below.

R = Responsible: The person(s) who owns and completes the project, task, or work.

A = Accountable: The person(s) who signs off on the work and who has final sign-off authority and is responsible for outcomes.

C = Consulted: The person(s) who has the ability or knowledge needed to complete the work. These are Subject Matter Experts (SME), or anyone else who can contribute consultatively to the task.

I = Informed: The person(s) who must be kept informed of the work but not necessarily consulted.

R	Responsible	A	Accountable	C	Consulted	I	Informed

Roles marked “Informed” or “Consulted” in the RACI matrix that are not elaborated on in this procedure have no procedural action requirements beyond those indicated.

Table 3: RACI Matrix

Position/Role	Monitor Conditions	Facilitate Decision to Change Status	Enable EPS – Approve & Execute Level 2	Preparation for PSPS – Authorize & Execute Level 3	Initiate PSPS – Approve & Execute Level 4
	Primary: WLMs & Met. After-hours & weekends: Sys Ops Supv.	Trigger evaluation; Operations Planning Call	Dir. of Electric Sys Control approves; Sys Ops Supv. executes	Dir. of Electric Sys Control authorizes	PSPS ECC Dir. & SVP approve; Sys Ops Supv. & Load Office execute
Primary Monitoring & Risk Assessment					
Meteorologist	R	R	C	C	C
WLM(s)	R	R	C	C	C
System Operations					
System Operations Supervisor	R	R	R	R	R
System Operations Manager	C	C	C	C	C
Load Office					
Load Office Supervisor	I	C	R	R	R
Load Office Manager	I	C	C	C	C
Electric Operations – Operational Management					
Director of Electric Operations	I	I	C	C	C

Position/Role	Monitor Conditions	Facilitate Decision to Change Status	Enable EPS – Approve & Execute Level 2	Preparation for PSPS – Authorize & Execute Level 3	Initiate PSPS – Approve & Execute Level 4
	Primary: WLMs & Met. After-hours & weekends: Sys Ops Supv.	Trigger evaluation; Operations Planning Call	Dir. of Electric Sys Control approves; Sys Ops Supv. executes	Dir. of Electric Sys Control authorizes	PSPS ECC Dir. & SVP approve; Sys Ops Supv. & Load Office execute
Director of Electric System Control	I	I	**A**	**A**	**C**
Manager of Electric Operations	I	I	I	I	I
Manager of Electric Operations – EFR	I	I	I	I	I
Supervisor of Energy Operations	I	I	I	I	I
Supervisor of EFR (Affected Area)	I	I	I	I	I
WRM					
WRM Manager	I	**C**	**C**	**C**	**C**
WRM Senior Program Manager	I	I	I	I	I
WRM Communications	I	I	I	I	I
Emergency Management & Corporate Functions					
Manager of EMR	I	I	I	**C**	**C**
Director of Communications	I	I	I	**C**	**C**
Director of Safety	I	I	I	I	I
Director of Gas Operations	I	I	I	I	I
Director of Generation	I	I	I	I	I
Corporate Security	I	I	I	I	I
Telecommunications	I	I	I	I	I
PSPS ECC Director (Rotating)					
PSPS ECC Director (rotating)	I	I	**C**	**R**	**R**
Executive Approval Authority					

Position/Role	Monitor Conditions	Facilitate Decision to Change Status	Enable EPS – Approve & Execute Level 2	Preparation for PSPS – Authorize & Execute Level 3	Initiate PSPS – Approve & Execute Level 4
	Primary: WLMs & Met. After-hours & weekends: Sys Ops Supv.	Trigger evaluation; Operations Planning Call	Dir. of Electric Sys Control approves; Sys Ops Supv. executes	Dir. of Electric Sys Control authorizes	PSPS ECC Dir. & SVP approve; Sys Ops Supv. & Load Office execute
VP of Gas & Electric Operations	I	C	C	C	A
Senior VP of Energy Operations	A	A	C	C	A

5 Prerequisites & Requirements

Successful execution of this procedure requires that core operational capabilities, systems, and coordination mechanisms are in place prior to and during elevated fire weather conditions. This includes established monitoring and situational awareness tools, clearly defined roles, and escalation paths.

At minimum, the following prerequisites are required:

- Access to current and reliable fire weather forecasts, Fire Weather Watches, Red Flag Warnings, and wildfire intelligence, including internal and external data sources used by PSE.
- Availability of operational systems and tools supporting outage management, load management, situational awareness, and field coordination.
- Clearly defined roles and responsibilities, including on-call coverage or duty assignments for System Operations, Load Office, **Electric First Response** (**EFR**), **Gas First Response** (**GFR**), Generation, WRM, EMR, Safety, Communications, and other impacted teams.
- Current procedural documentation and communication protocols to support timely decision-making and cross-functional coordination.
- Alignment with existing emergency response, incident command, safety, and regulatory requirements, including appropriate escalation and notification thresholds.

These prerequisites are intended to ensure that PSE is positioned to respond consistently and effectively to elevated and Critical Fire Weather conditions, and to scale operational actions based on changing risk and system impacts.

6 Procedure

6.1 Operational Summary

PSE's **Wildfire Liaison Managers (WLMs) and** Meteorologist monitor the **National Weather Service's** (**NWS**) Critical Fire Weather Watches and Warnings and work closely with System Operations to determine when conditions warrant action on PSE's electrical system to mitigate ignition risk. They also

monitor interagency predictive services and outlooks and forecast-driven wildfire-risk outputs (e.g., Technosylva FireRisk) to target any required actions at the circuit or zone level.

Based on these inputs, PSE designates a daily Operational Level (1–4) with predefined operational actions and clear accountabilities. Table 4 summarizes each Level's weather indicators for consideration, recommended actions, and decision and approval path. For a high-level visual overview of the full operational timeline from 72 hours out through restoration, see Figure 2 in Appendix C.

Table 4: Summary of Critical Fire Weather Actions and Accountability

Level	Weather Indicators	Recommended Actions	Decision & Approval
1	• Routine Operations • No critical fire-weather indicators present	Continue monitoring for changing conditions.	WLMs and Meteorologist
2	• Elevated fire-weather conditions are identified, or • Red Flag Warning issued, or Red Flag criteria forecast to be met, and • Trigger threshold for wind gust forecast to be met	Disable reclosing on high-risk transmission lines (if not already disabled).	Load Office Supervisor
		Enable EPS on applicable EPS-Capable Circuits within the affected substation(s).	System Operations Supervisor determines feasibility; FDSO coordinates execution
		Where feasible, apply block reclosing and the hot line work switch (HLWS) to non-EPS-capable circuits within the affected substation(s).	System Operations Supervisor determines feasibility; FDSO coordinates execution
		Develop recommendation to move to Level 3 or remain at Level 2.	System Operations Supervisor
		If Level 3 is recommended, present recommendation to the PSPS ECC Director.	System Operations Supervisor
3	• Severe (elevated) fire weather forecasted, or • Level 2 criteria forecasted or met • Pacific Northwest 7-Day Significant Fire Potential is elevated or high-risk • FireRisk analysis identifies one or more of	Open and staff ECC with IMT.	System Operations Supervisor
		• Conduct fire analysis • Develop PSPS plan, per the IAP – Include identifying specific circuits and transmission sections to de-energize	Planning Section Chief
		Perform reliability assessment for any transmission lines identified as part of the PSPS.	Load Office Supervisor

Level	Weather Indicators	Recommended Actions	Decision & Approval
	the metrics at trigger levels: – FBI score of 4 or 5 – FPIC score of 4 or 5 – Probability of Failure: ≥10% – FSP: ≥500 acres	• Develop and implement notification plans, including timeline and key messages for internal and external parties • Determine whether CIO is needed • Determine if CRC (e.g., FireDawg) is needed	Communications Lead and PIO
		• Develop de-energization action plan • Identify field resources to implement for PSPS and determine whether mutual assistance is needed • Determine whether regional storm bases will be activated	Operations Section Chief
		Establish de-energization timeline.	Operations Section Chief
		Communicate de-energization plan to applicable parties.	Operations Section Chief
		Develop recommendation to move to Level 4.	PSPS ECC Director
		Approve implementation of PSPS plan.	Senior Vice President of Energy Operations or designee
4	• Severe (elevated) fire weather forecast • Level 2 criteria met • Pacific Northwest 7-Day Significant Fire Potential is elevated or high-risk • FireRisk metrics at trigger levels are the same as Level 3	Communicate De-energization Operations Plan with PSPS ECC Director, Operations Leadership, MLM, Business Services and PIO.	Operations Section Chief
		• Approve plan to proceed with: – PSPS preparation – Staging of resources – Opening regional storm bases and acquiring outside resources as needed	PSPS ECC Director
		• Inform ECC staff and the PSPS ECC Director that: – All field resources are staged – Storm bases are open – Real-time field weather conditions continue to align with forecast – System operations and load offices are ready	Operations Section Chief

Level	Weather Indicators	Recommended Actions	Decision & Approval
		Provide final approval to proceed with PSPS – Level 4 de-energization.	• PSPS ECC Director • Senior Vice President of Energy Operations
		Proceed with de-energization of applicable transmission and distribution circuits.	• System Operations Supervisor • Load Office Supervisor
		Develop restoration plan.	Operations Section Chief

6.2 Ignition Threat Identification

Ignition threat identification begins with recognizing when a weather event or condition may pose an ignition risk to PSE's electrical system. This process consists of two components: annual risk assessment and continual monitoring.

6.3 Annual Assessment

The annual assessment occurs before the PSE Wildfire Season and identifies distribution circuits and transmission lines with elevated fire threat rankings. These assets are analyzed using the following criteria:

- Field input incorporated by the EFR
- Historical wind and fire weather patterns, including correlations between extreme weather events and past system impacts
- Historical fuel conditions, with emphasis on long-term trends in vegetation dryness and combustibility
- Fuel loading immediately surrounding the circuits, assessing vegetation density and proximity that may contribute to ignition risk or fire spread

Based on the Technosylva **High Fire Threat** (**HFT**) Index, each asset is assigned a fire threat score ranging from 0 to 1. As of 2026, PSE generally defines HFT lines and circuits as assets with an HFT Index score greater than 0.475. Assets with an HFT Index score at or below this threshold that meet additional PSE-defined risk criteria are designated as Moderate Fire Threat (MFT). The 2026 WRM Priority Circuits — the operational reference used throughout Section 6 for EPS and alternative mitigation actions — comprise all HFT circuits, MFT circuits meeting a PSE-defined priority threshold, and additional circuits identified through EFR field feedback or other PSE-defined criteria.

Assets associated with an HFT line or circuit are patrolled for vegetation, asset management, and repair prior to July 1, which is the historical starting period of elevated fire activity in PSE's service territory. The specific PSE Wildfire Seasons for each zone are declared and concluded in accordance with the *PSE Wildfire Season Declaration Procedure*.

6.4 Continual Monitoring

Focused monitoring is conducted jointly by PSE's WLMs and the PSE Meteorologist, who work closely together to track wildfire-related conditions throughout the PSE Wildfire Season. The WLMs and Meteorologist provide active monitoring Monday–Friday from 7:00 a.m. to 7:00 p.m. Extended hours are included during Critical Fire Weather events or when conditions warrant heightened situational awareness to support threat evaluation, ensuring alignment on fire weather intelligence, and facilitating timely decision-making.

During PSE Wildfire Season, the System Operations Supervisor maintains after-hours and weekend continual monitoring of situational awareness sources, including weather forecasts, active wildfires, and historical fire weather operations data. The System Operations Supervisor has direct access to the 24-hour on-call WLM for escalation, coordination, and response support (see Section 8.1 for 24-hour On-Call WLM contact information).

6.5 Monitoring Resources

6.5.1 Primary Resources

1. **PSE Meteorologist**
   The PSE Meteorologist provides tailored, utility-specific Critical Fire Weather forecasting, interprets model outputs, identifies emerging wildfire-related threats, and delivers expert guidance on the timing, severity, and location of Critical Fire Weather conditions. The Meteorologist works closely with the WLMs to coordinate risk assessment and ensure consistent interpretation of fire weather indicators. Additionally, the Meteorologist produces a daily forecast across the service territory, including a comprehensive analysis of all emergent threats, with emphasis on potential Critical Fire Weather conditions. Forecast products are distributed via email Monday–Friday.
2. **WLMs**
   The WLMs support situational awareness by monitoring wildfire indicators, maintaining external agency coordination, and working closely with the PSE Meteorologist to ensure a consistent understanding of fire weather conditions. WLMs also prepare a weekly PSE Wildfire Situation Briefing, which is incorporated into the Monday weather forecast distributed by the PSE Meteorologist. In addition, WLMs communicate emerging risks to System Operations and provide subject-matter support to operational decision-making during the PSE Wildfire Season.
3. **Technosylva FireRisk**
   Technosylva FireRisk is PSE's fire risk modeling platform, providing predictive fire weather analytics, ignition potential, spread modeling, and zone-level risk outputs. FireRisk serves as a key decision-support tool and delivers daily critical wildfire intelligence. See Appendix A for additional details.

6.5.2 Secondary Resources

1. **NWS**
   The NWS provides official fire weather forecasts, advisories, watches, and warnings, including Fire Weather Watches and Red Flag Warnings. These products support situational awareness by identifying periods of potential or imminent Critical Fire Weather conditions. Fire Weather Watch and Red Flag Warning issuances are determined by professional judgment of the NWS

Meteorologist and are not strictly objective or formula-based. The NWS is available upon request to provide spot forecasts on a 24-hour basis (see Section 8.1 for NWS contact information). Refer to the NWS Washington Fire Weather Zones Map for zone boundaries.

During PSE Wildfire Season, WLMs participate in NWS Fire Weather Briefings, typically conducted on a twice-weekly basis. Briefing frequency and duration are adjusted earlier or later in the year, as dictated by fire weather conditions. NWS regional forecast offices provide additional area-specific outlooks that support wildfire monitoring across PSE's service territory:

- Seattle/Tacoma, WA Office (Western Washington)
- Spokane, WA Office (Eastern Washington)
- Pendleton, OR Office (Eastern Washington)

2. **Washington State Department of Natural Resources (DNR)**

   WLMs participate in DNR's Statewide Wildfire Briefings, typically conducted on a twice-weekly basis during PSE Wildfire Season. Briefing frequency and duration are adjusted earlier or later in the year, as dictated by fire weather conditions.

3. **Western Weather Group (WWG)**

   The WWG provides specialized meteorological insights and utility-oriented forecast products that supplement and help validate PSE's internal fire weather forecasting. The WWG delivers a daily forecast across the service territory, offering generalized weather information by geographic region and incorporating data from PSE's network of weather stations. Forecasts are distributed via email Monday–Friday, with additional updates provided as needed when weather conditions evolve.

   > **NOTE** PSE has an agreement with WWG for backup meteorological services (see Section 8.1 for WWG contact information).

4. **Pacific Northwest 7-Day Significant Fire Potential**

   The Pacific Northwest 7-Day Significant Fire Potential provides a regional 7-day outlook of expected fire activity, including large fire potential and multi-day trends across the Pacific Northwest. The product categorizes fire environment conditions into four levels, offering a clear assessment of short-term and extended fire risk potential for the areas covered. Open the 7-day outlook to view the Pacific Northwest 7-Day Significant Fire Potential.

6.5.3 Field & Observational Resources

1. **PSE Weather Stations**: Localized real-time data for temperature, wind, humidity, and gust behavior.
2. **PSE Field Personnel**: Field personnel provide real-time, subjective observations of fuel conditions, visibility, smoke, wind behavior, and any anomalies impacting the electrical system.

> **NOTE** Field personnel immediately notify the on-shift System Operator upon identification of any unforecasted critical conditions that present an immediate risk to the electrical system. The on-shift System Operator takes protective action at the breaker level on the requested circuit, enabling EPS where available. Where a requested circuit is not EPS-capable, the on-shift System Operator immediately dispatches field resources to block reclosing and apply the hot line work switch at the breaker, whether via SCADA or by mobilizing the substation inspector directly. If field personnel recommend expanding protective actions beyond the requested circuit, the on-shift System Operator relays the recommendation to the System Operations Supervisor, who determines whether further analysis and escalation are warranted. The on-shift System Operator notifies the System Operations Supervisor of all actions taken.

The System Operations Supervisor immediately escalates to Level 2 for the associated circuits without the need for an Operations Planning Call or the Director of Electric System Control's approval. Afterwards, the System Operations Supervisor populates an **Operational Action Recommendation** (**OAR**) for current conditions and hosts an Operations Planning Call for awareness and to discuss de-escalation timing. See Section 6.7.3 for EPS – Level 2 procedures.

6.6 Fire Ignition Risk Analysis

Once forecasts indicate the potential for Critical Fire Weather conditions, System Operations and the Load Office – in close coordination with the PSE Meteorologist and WLMs – conduct a deeper evaluation of the available data. This assessment focuses on identifying and anticipating wildfire-related risks or system vulnerabilities, considering operational context, and determining the appropriate response actions. The combination of the Meteorologist's utility-specific fire weather analysis and the WLMs' situational intelligence and agency coordination supports the early identification of emerging fire weather threats and their timely, informed mitigation.

6.7 Critical Fire Weather Mitigation Actions

Responding to Critical Fire Weather conditions requires prompt, coordinated, and effective actions to operate safely and reduce the likelihood of PSE assets contributing to potential wildfire ignition. Operational actions – including activating the **Emergency Coordination Center** (**ECC**), maintaining communications with internal and external stakeholders, and supporting customers – must be prioritized and executed in a timely and organized manner.

The following sections outline PSE's response across all Operational Levels, including Routine Operations, activation of Level 2 settings, and the planning, initiation, and restoration of a **Public Safety Power Shutoff** (**PSPS**). Approval requirements for each operational action are included within each subsection. When a specific position is identified, a designee may fulfill that responsibility as needed.

6.7.1 Routine Operations – Level 1

Routine Operations represent baseline conditions where no Critical Fire Weather indicators are present. During PSE Wildfire Season, situational awareness is maintained through monitoring using Technosylva FireRisk, the PSE Meteorologist, WLMs, and other resources outlined in Sections 6.5.2 and 6.5.3. PSE has defined the following criteria to guide escalation and de-escalation discussions during Critical Fire Weather conditions.

Routine conditions generally include the following:

- No Red Flag Warnings forecasted
- Weather conditions fall below the thresholds listed in Table 4.

When a Red Flag Warning, Wind Advisory, or similar elevated Critical Fire Weather condition is forecasted, the PSE Meteorologist notifies the System Operations Supervisor, who then posts an initial awareness notice in the ECC Team's General Channel and completes the following actions:

1. Review the forecast with support from the PSE Meteorologist and WLMs to determine whether conditions meet or exceed Level 2 escalation criteria.
2. Coordinate with key roles, as needed:
    a. Meteorologist – Interpret Critical Fire Weather data and forecast severity and timing
    b. WLMs – Provide wildfire-specific situational intelligence and agency updates
    c. Load Office Supervisor – Assess status of impacted transmission segments
    d. Regional Lead Operator – Assess status of impacted distribution circuits and any abnormal conditions
3. Determine escalation threshold and prepare documentation.
    a. **If thresholds are NOT met**:
        i. Post the following update in the ECC Team's General Channel: "No action required at this time. Continuing to monitor the situation."
    b. **If thresholds are met**:
        i. Open the Operational Action Recommendation Template.
        ii. Click **File** → **Create a Copy** → **Download a Copy**.
        iii. Open the file and click **File** → **Save As**.
        iv. Navigate to **Emergency Coordination Center** → **Operations Section** → **Wildfire Mitigation** → **Completed OARs**.
        v. Rename the copy using the format: **OAR-MM-DD-YYYY**.
        vi. Click **Save**.
        vii. Complete the OAR copy in preparation for the Operations Planning Call using current forecast and system data.
4. Use the completed OAR to determine if escalation is recommended, then coordinate the Operations Planning Call with required participants (see Section 6.7.2).

6.7.2 Operations Planning Call

To escalate or de-escalate, the System Operations Supervisor must ensure that relevant information is compiled and presented to the correct decision-makers. Prior to any Operations Planning Call regarding escalation, the System Operations Supervisor – in collaboration with the Load Office, Regional Lead Operator, PSE Meteorologist, and WLMs – completes an OAR. The OAR provides a consolidated summary of the current weather and forecast Critical Fire Weather conditions, identified assets under threat, system status, and recommended actions.

Once the OAR is complete, the System Operations Supervisor coordinates the Operations Planning Call with the following personnel listed in Table 5:

Table 5: Operations Planning Call Participants

EPS – Level 2	PSPS – Level 3
Construction Performance Management	All personnel from Level 2
EFR Supervisor for Impacted Area(s)	Bothell Emergency Center Manager
Electric Operations Managers	ECC Manager
EMR Team	Emergency Response Duty Officer
Director of Communications – Communications & Marketing	IT Unit Lead
Director of Electric Operations	Logistics Section Chief
Director of Electric System Control	Manager of Communications – Permitting & Restoration
Load Office Supervisor	Manager of Digital Marketing and Brand Communications Strategy
Potelco On-Duty Director	Manager of Internal Employee Communications
PSPS ECC Director (rotating): Director of Engineering & GIS, Director of Electric Operations, Director of Planning, or Director of Electric System Control	Operations Section Chief
Safety Duty Supervisor	PIO
Senior Vice President of Energy Operations	Planning Section Chief
Substation Duty Supervisor and Supervisor for impacted area(s)	Supervisor of Communications – Major Projects & Initiatives
System Operations Supervisors	Supervisor of New Media and Reputation – Brand and Marketing Enablement
Vice President of Gas & Electric Operations	
WRM Team	

Following the Operations Planning Call, the System Operations Supervisor advances to EPS – Level 2 or PSPS Planning – Level 3 as directed, pending the required approvals outlined in Sections 6.7.3 and 6.7.4.1, respectively. The System Operations Supervisor must complete all Level 2 actions (see Section 6.7.3) prior to escalating to Level 3, unless otherwise directed during the Operations Planning Call.

6.7.3 Enable EPS – Level 2

The System Operations Supervisor considers enabling Level 2 settings when one or more of the criteria identified in Table 6 are met. When any Table 6 criterion is met, the System Operations Supervisor evaluates Level 2 implementation for all circuits emanating from the substation(s) affected by that

criterion. Where a substation's circuits span more than one NWS fire weather zone, Level 2 implementation applies only to the circuits within the zone(s) meeting the triggering criterion; circuits within unaffected zones served by the same substation are not included by default.

Wind gust thresholds are evaluated per individual circuit, per the Wind Gust Limits – 2026 Fire Season Spreadsheet. If Level 2 actions are deemed necessary, circuits that are EPS-capable will have EPS enabled. For circuits that are not EPS-capable, the System Operations Supervisor directs evaluation of alternative operational strategies (block reclosing and/or hot line work switch, through SCADA-controlled operation or manual implementation) per Section 6.7.3.1.

Table 6: Elevated Critical Fire Weather Risk Criteria

Subcategory/Region	Condition	Threshold/Requirement
NWS	Red Flag Warning	A Red Flag Warning is issued by the NWS
West Slopes (Seattle NWS Office)	Relative humidity	30% or less
West Slopes (Seattle NWS Office)	Wind gusts exceed actionable thresholds	See link for Substation Wind Gust Limits – 2026 Fire Season Spreadsheet: Substation Wind Gust Limits - 2026 Fire Season.xlsx
East Slopes (Spokane/Pendleton NWS Offices)	Relative humidity	25% or less
East Slopes (Spokane/Pendleton NWS Offices)	Wind gusts exceed actionable thresholds	See link for Substation Wind Gust Limits – 2026 Fire Season Spreadsheet: Substation Wind Gust Limits - 2026 Fire Season.xlsx

Escalation to Level 2 is approved by the Director of Electric System Control. If unavailable, the Director of Electric System Control assigns one of the following designees to approve the escalation to Level 2 based on recommendations developed during the Operations Planning Call:

- Director of Electric Operations
- Director of Engineering and **Geographic Information Systems** (**GIS**)
- Director of Planning

Once Level 2 is activated, the System Operations Supervisor serves as the central point of control and coordinates the actions required to implement Level 2 settings across all impacted circuits within the substation(s), or within the affected fire weather zone(s) where a substation's circuits span more than one zone. WLMs continue to monitor conditions with support from the PSE Meteorologist, System Operations Supervisor, and Load Office Supervisor, focusing on those Critical Fire Weather indicators that may drive further escalation. System Operations maintains situational awareness and prepares for a possible transition to PSPS – Level 3, informed by updated guidance from the Meteorologist, WLMs, and the Load Office.

6.7.3.1 Escalation – Enable EPS – Level 2

Once the Director of Electric System Control (or designee) approves escalation to Level 2, the System Operations Supervisor coordinates and executes the actions below. These actions span five functional areas: internal communications, **Advanced Distribution Management System** (**ADMS**) configuration, **Fire Danger System Operator** (**FDSO**) staffing, EPS activation, and required logging.

> **NOTE** See Appendix D for the Level 2 Escalation Checklist – a printable, role-labeled execution checklist covering all actions in this section.

1. **Internal Communications:**

   Notify all relevant stakeholders of the Level 2 escalation and ensure the appropriate communication channels are activated. Complete all of the following:

   a. Post an update in the ECC Team's General Channel and tag "Fire Weather Comms" in the post. Tagging this group notifies the Wildfire Communications Team, who will update the PSE web banner and distribute external talking points to community affairs, government affairs, and the call center. If after business hours, call the 24-hour Public Info Hotline (see Section 8.1).

   b. Contact all interconnected customers and utilities by phone, as defined in the OAR, to advise that EPS activation may affect their operations.

   c. Send an email to the "Fire Weather Event Response" list. Include: the forecast and escalation timeline, when settings must be in place, the expected return-to-normal time, and a staffing table for all System Operations and field personnel assigned to the event.

2. **Regional Lead Operator Activation**

   a. Provide the Regional Lead Operator with the list of impacted circuits and associated substations identified for Level 2 settings activation, including all applicable EPS-capable circuits and any non-EPS-Capable circuits requiring alternative operational strategies (block reclosing and/or hot line work switch).

   b. The Regional Lead Operator establishes incidents in ADMS to track fire-danger actions, beginning with the event incident, then transfers incident management to the FDSO upon completion and remains available to assist as needed.

3. **FDSO Staffing**

   a. Staff an **FDSO** for the full duration of the event. Initiate the FDSO callout immediately upon Level 2 approval.

   b. If immediate coverage is required before the designated FDSO arrives, assign the most qualified on-shift operator to temporarily fill the role and redistribute their region coverage to other on-shift operators.

4. **Storm Mode Activation**

   Enable Storm Mode in the ADMS for all EPS-capable circuits and any non-EPS-capable circuit on which hot line work switch and/or blocked reclosing will be applied, up to an hour before initiation. Use storm reason: **FD <Region> MM/DD/YYYY**.

5. **EPS Activation**
   a. Stand by and confirm completion of each action before proceeding to logging.
   b. FDSO: Coordinate with field resources to enable EPS on all applicable EPS-capable circuits within the affected substation(s). For circuits without EPS capability, the System Operations Supervisor evaluates the feasibility of applying block reclosing and the hot line work switch, through SCADA-controlled operation or manual implementation. Where feasible, these actions are completed in advance of EPS activation, targeting 30 minutes prior. The FDSO documents any actions not completed, including the reason, in the event incident within ADMS. The FDSO notifies the System Operations Supervisor when all applicable assets are complete.
   c. Load Office Supervisor and Power Dispatcher: Evaluate all designated transmission line segments and take the following actions, then notify the System Operations Supervisor upon completion:
      i. Disable reclosing on identified high-risk transmission lines, if not already disabled due to PSE Wildfire Season.
      ii. De-energize identified transmission line segments, if not already de-energized due to PSE Wildfire Season.
      iii. Log the status of all reclosing actions and transmission line segment changes in the **Integrated Transmission Operations Application** (**iTOA**).
6. **Required Logging**

   Once all activation actions above are confirmed complete, complete the following documentation to ensure full traceability of the Level 2 escalation:

   a. Log the escalation in the Wildfire Critical Decision Tracker, including the time-stamped approving authority and the applicable criterion reference.
   b. Log confirmation in the event incident in ADMS that EPS has been enabled on all applicable EPS-capable circuits within the affected substations (within the affected fire weather zones), that alternative operational strategies (block reclosing and/or HLWS) have been applied where feasible to any non-EPS-capable circuit within those substations, and that all Level 2 actions are complete.
   c. Reply to the “Fire Weather Event Response” email list using **Reply All**, confirming that all actions have been taken and EPS is enabled.

6.7.3.2 Operational Modifications

The System Operations Supervisor may consult the PSE Meteorologist and WLMs for updated fire weather timing, agency intelligence, and restoration implications. Unless otherwise noted in this procedure or directed by the Operations Planning Call, the System Operations Supervisor (or designee) completes the following operational modifications. These modifications apply when Critical Fire Weather conditions warrant an escalated response level under EPS – Level 2 and preparation for PSPS – Level 3.

1. System Operations Supervisor: Maintain oversight and logging.
    a. The System Operations Supervisor serves as the central point of control and logs event-level entries on the event incident.
    b. The Regional Lead Operator provides support, as directed.
2. The following defines the FDSO's scope and authority during EPS – Level 2 and PSPS – Level 3 events (see Section 6.7.3.1, Item 3 for staffing procedures).
    a. An FDSO is staffed 24/7 for the duration of the event.
    b. The FDSO assumes operational authority over distribution circuits and substations within the fire danger area for the duration of the event.
    c. The FDSO is responsible for dispatch and operations within that jurisdiction.
    d. The FDSO logs all actions taken in ADMS.
3. Complete patrol requirements.
    a. The Troublemen patrol all downstream feeders and laterals of an open device prior to re-energization.
    b. The FDSO logs an entry using the required template.
        i. **Required Log Entry Template**: *"All feeder and lateral lines from [device X] to the end are up and in the clear. Ready to energize the line."*
    c. If field conditions are not safe enough to restore the line, the Troublemen notify the FDSO, who will then:
        i. Change the associated incident cause code to: **Delayed Restoration – Fire Concern**.
        ii. Update the ETR, as accurately as possible.
        iii. Log an entry indicating the reason for delayed restoration.
        iv. Notify the System Operations Supervisor, who will then complete the following:
            1) Post in the ECC Team's General Channel the information above and the number and general location of customers impacted.
            2) Tag "Fire Weather Comms" to ensure the message is noticed.
            3) If after business hours, call the 24-hour Public Info Hotline.
    d. Temporarily disable EPS on upstream devices during energization.
    e. Proceed with restoration when conditions become safe, per this procedure.
4. Conduct hot line patrols after re-energizing a line where the cause of the outage is unknown.
5. Ensure elevated field resource availability in the fire danger area to support patrols, restoration, and unforeseen operational needs.
6. When Level 2 settings are implemented for a circuit (or planned to be implemented), the following work restrictions apply to that circuit:
    - No planned construction activities

- No customer-driven appointments
  - Planned appointments for disconnection and reconnection
- No hot work activities, as outlined in the PSE Employee Safety and Health Program

7. As needed, consult the PSE Meteorologist and WLMs for updated Critical Fire Weather timing, agency intelligence, and implications for patrol, restoration, or potential escalation and de-escalation.

6.7.3.3 Transmission Patrol Expectations in Operational Level 2 or Higher

1. EFR Troublemen patrol all planned and unplanned outages of identified HFT transmission lines in their entirety prior to re-energizing. This includes HFT lines that experience an outage due to a different HFT line tripping.
2. Short-duration outages (i.e., drop and pick evolutions) that last less than 10 minutes do not require a patrol prior to re-energizing the HFT transmission line.
3. If the cause is not found during the initial patrol, the Load Office Transmission Dispatcher re-energizes the HFT transmission line and EFR Troublemen re-patrol the line while hot.

6.7.3.4 Ongoing Monitoring and Escalation Decisions

1. The System Operations Supervisor continues to monitor weather indicators with support from the PSE Meteorologist and WLMs.
2. The System Operations Supervisor updates the OAR when conditions reach PSPS – Level 3 thresholds, or when FireRisk metrics meet provisional trigger ranges, per Table 4.
3. The System Operations Supervisor coordinates the next Operations Planning Call based on the updated recommendation.
4. The System Operations Supervisor recommends preparation for PSPS – Level 3, if necessary.

6.7.3.5 De-escalation – Return to Routine Operations

The Vice President of Gas and Electric Operations (or designee) defines the **All Clear** timing based on recommendations provided during the Operations Planning Call. The System Operations Supervisor coordinates the return to Routine Operations based on this defined **All Clear** timing. However, if Red Flag Conditions subside early, the System Operations Supervisor confers with the System Operations Manager and the PSPS ECC Director to determine whether it is feasible to return to Routine Operations before the scheduled **All Clear** timing. If feasible, the System Operations Supervisor proceeds with the steps below.

1. **Documentation**
   a. The System Operations Supervisor logs the **All Clear** in the Wildfire Critical Decision Tracker.
   b. The System Operations Supervisor logs the **All Clear** on the event incident in ADMS.
2. **All Clear Notifications**

   The System Operations Supervisor notifies the FDSO and the Load Office Supervisor of the **All Clear**.

3. **System Configuration**

   The System Operations Supervisor disables **Storm Mode** in ADMS for distribution circuits and substations designated as **All Clear**.

4. **Restoration Actions**

   a. The FDSO completes the following actions:

      i. Coordinate with field resources to restore pre-escalation settings on all circuits on which Level 2 settings were applied.

      ii. Notify the System Operations Supervisor when restoration is complete.

   b. The Load Office Supervisor and Power Dispatcher complete the following actions:

      i. Restore designated transmission line segments to pre-escalation status.

      ii. Notify the System Operations Supervisor when complete.

   c. Log designated distribution and transmission assets as returned to normal settings and confirm return to Routine Operations.

5. **Routine Operations Notifications**

   a. The System Operations Supervisor notifies stakeholders that systems have returned to Routine Operations by taking the following actions:

      i. Post in the ECC Team's General Channel.

      ii. Tag "Fire Weather Comms" to ensure that the web banner is removed.

      iii. If after hours, call the 24-hour Public Info Hotline.

      iv. Contact interconnected customers, as defined in the OAR, to confirm return to Routine Operations.

      v. Reply to the "Fire Weather Event Response" email list using **Reply All**, confirming that all actions have been taken and systems have returned to Routine Operations.

6. **FDSO Release**

   The System Operations Supervisor releases the FDSO position.

   a. The on-shift FDSO may complete their shift.

   b. Pre-scheduled FDSOs are notified that fire weather conditions have cleared and that reporting is no longer required.

7. **Incident Transition**

   The on-shift System Operator resumes jurisdiction of all remaining incidents.

6.7.3.6 Level 2 Fault Occurrence Notification – Eastern Washington

PSE has entered into a **Memorandum of Understanding** (**MOU**) with the DNR in Eastern Washington. The intent of this MOU is to allow the fire response agencies to initiate a fire response as early as possible for a potential ignition if they choose. When a fault occurs under Level 2 settings in Eastern Washington with either the distribution or transmission systems, the System Operations or Load Office Supervisor must notify the **Central Washington Interagency Communication Center** (**CWICC**) (see

Section 8.1 for contact information). The System Operations or Load Office Supervisor provides the fault location or general area, advises that there is no known report of fire at this time, and states that EFR is being dispatched to investigate. The System Operations or Load Office Supervisor uses the following script as guidance:

"We are calling you per our MOU to advise that our utility line has detected a fault in [location]. At this time, we have no report of fire and are dispatching EFR to investigate."

6.7.4 Preparation for PSPS – Level 3

Escalation to PSPS (Level 3 or higher) is considered when Level 2 criteria are forecast or already met and additional indicators demonstrate elevated or critical wildfire-risk potential. No single factor alone triggers escalation; rather, the System Operations Supervisor, Load Office Supervisor, PSE Meteorologist, and WLMs evaluate a combination of risk indicators to determine whether conditions warrant advancing to PSPS-level actions.

> **NOTE** The operational modifications defined in Section 6.7.3.2 apply during PSPS – Level 3 when EPS – Level 2 escalation is necessary. Refer to Section 6.7.3.2 for all applicable operational modifications.

6.7.4.1 Fire Risk Criteria

Fire risk criteria are the Pacific Northwest's 7-Day Significant Fire Potential classified as **Elevated** or **High Risk**. FireRisk analysis identifies one or more of the following metrics at trigger levels:

- **Fire Behavior Index** (**FBI**) score of 4 or 5
- **Fire Potential Index Composite** (**FPIC**) score of 4 or 5
- Probability of fault greater than or equal to 10%
- **Fire Size Potential** (**FSP**) greater than 500 acres

6.7.4.2 Meteorological Evaluation

The System Operations Supervisor, in coordination with the PSE Meteorologist and WLMs, reviews meteorological and Critical Fire Weather indicators, which may include:

- **ERC** (**Energy Release Component**) trends
- Fuel conditions
- Daily relative humidity recovery
- Sustained wind speed

6.7.4.3 Authorization & Initiation

The Director of Electric System Control (or designee) authorizes the preparation for PSPS – Level 3 based on the recommendations from the Operations Planning Call (see Table 5 for Operations Planning Call participants).

1. **System Operations Supervisor**
   a. Notify internal stakeholders of escalation to Level 3 with a brief summary of the Operations Planning Call.
   b. Post an update in the ECC Team's General Channel (owned by System Operations Leadership).

c. Initiate opening of the ECC.

2. **ECC Activation and Incident Management Team (IMT) Stand-Up**

   a. The System Operations Supervisor initiates opening the ECC and staffs it with a designated PSPS ECC Director trained for PSPS.

      i. The PSPS ECC Director begins staffing the following IMT positions upon Level 3 activation, targeting full staffing no later than 72 hours before anticipated PSPS de-energization:

         - ECC Manager
         - Safety Officer
         - EMR Liaison
         - **Public Information Officer** (**PIO**)
         - Legal Consultant
         - Operations Section Chief
         - Deputy Operations Section Chief
         - Planning Section Chief
         - Logistics Section Chief
         - Meteorologist
         - Wildfire Liaison
         - Wildfire Analyst
         - Community Outreach Liaison
         - GIS Support
         - Potelco On-Duty Director

      ii. The PSPS ECC Director adds the following IMT positions 48 hours before anticipated PSPS de-energization:

         - Business Services
         - IT Manager
         - Finance & Admin Section Chief

      iii. The PSPS ECC Director may expand IMT roles as necessary. The IMT hierarchy and roles are defined in Appendix B – Incident Management Team.

3. **Turnover & Initial Planning (Planning Section)**

   a. The System Operations Supervisor turns over current system conditions to the ECC, including the OAR.

   b. The Planning Section Chief conducts a current fire analysis and identifies specific assets of concern.

   c. The Planning Section Chief references PSPS – Level 3 trigger thresholds as initial criteria.

d. The Planning Section Chief documents analysis and plans in the PSPS IAP.

i. The Planning Section Chief requests input for relevant **Incident Action Plan** (**IAP**) sections from the PSE Meteorologist.

ii. The PSE Meteorologist documents weather conditions leading to ECC activation and forecast indicating a need for the PSPS.

iii. The WLMs and/or Wildfire Analyst continue to monitor Technosylva FireRisk and provide updates.

1) If transmission is included, the Load Office performs a reliability assessment to determine the impact of the de-energization on PSE's ability to serve load.

2) The Operations Section and System Operations identify:

- Circuit(s) to be de-energized
- Action plan to isolate impacted circuit(s)
- Options to limit customer impact
- Estimated number of impacted customers
- Managed account impacts
- Draft of impacted customers list

3) The PIO drafts a PSPS Notification Execution Plan and timelines.

4) The Planning Section Chief is responsible for scheduling the Partner Briefing, with input from the ECC Director and support from the PIO and Communications Lead.

4. PSPS ECC Director – Leadership Notification and IAP Distribution

a. The PSPS ECC Director informs PSE leadership, Washington Department of Commerce, Washington **Emergency Management Division** (**EMD**), and the Washington **Utilities and Transportation Commission** (**UTC**) of the potential for a PSPS.

b. Upon IAP approval, the PSPS ECC Director distributes the IAP highlights to the internal stakeholders, per the ECC storm protocols.

c. The ECC communicates the approved PSPS IAP with associated timelines to the System Operations Supervisor, the Load Office Supervisor, and storm bases to allow preparations to begin.

5. Messaging Cadence – PIO and Communications Lead

a. Notification Plan and Initial Messages:

i. The PIO drafts the PSPS Notification Execution Plan as soon as possible after opening the ECC; the Communications Lead reviews it and includes it in the IAP.

ii. The PIO drafts the initial messages, the Communications Lead reviews them, and the PSPS ECC Director approves them.

b. 72–48 hours before PSPS – Partner Briefing:

i. The PIO drafts briefing messages, the Communications Lead reviews them, and the PSPS ECC Director approves them.

ii. The PIO includes briefing messages in the Situation Report.

c. **72–48 hours before PSPS – PSPS Watch:**

i. The PIO drafts PSPS Watch messages, the Communications Lead reviews them, and the PSPS ECC Director approves them.

ii. The PIO includes Watch messages in the Situation Report.

d. **48 hours before PSPS – PSPS Warning:**

i. The PIO drafts PSPS Warning messages, the Communications Lead reviews them, and the PSPS ECC Director approves them.

ii. The PIO includes briefing messages in the Situation Report.

e. **48–4 hours before PSPS – Twice Daily Updates:**

i. The PIO updates the messages for the Situation Reports.

ii. The PIO sends the updates to customers per the PSPS Notification Execution Plan.

f. **4 hours before PSPS – PSPS Imminent:** The PIO drafts PSPS Imminent messages, the Communications Lead reviews them, and the PSPS ECC Director approves them.

g. **Shutoff – Restoration:**

i. The PIO updates messages for the Situation Reports.

ii. Communications cadence follows storm protocols after the outage begins.

6. **Partner Alerts & Updates**

The PIO and/or the Communications Lead coordinate the following:

a. **Regulatory Notifications**: As soon as possible after opening the ECC, send Tier 1 Partner Alerts via the ACTNow application.

b. **72–48 hours before PSPS – Partner Briefing**: Send partner briefing details to Tier 1 and Tier 2 Partner Alert lists via the ACTNow application.

c. **72–48 hours before PSPS – PSPS Watch**:

i. Share Watch messages with government affairs, community affairs, **Municipal Liaison Managers (MLMs)**, and Key Account Managers.

ii. Send Tier 1, 2, and 3 PSPS Watch Partner Alerts via the ACTNow application.

d. **48 hours before PSPS – PSPS Warning**:

i. Share Warning messages with government affairs, community affairs, MLMs, and Key Account Managers.

ii. Send Tier 1, 2, and 3 PSPS Warning Partner Alerts via the ACTNow application.

e. **48–4 hours before PSPS – Twice Daily Updates**: Send Tier 1, 2, and 3 Partner updates twice daily.

f. **4 hours before PSPS – PSPS Imminent**: Send Tier 1, 2, and 3 PSPS Imminent Partner Alerts via the ACTNow application.

g. **Shutoff – Restoration**:
   i. Update messages for the Situation Reports.
   ii. Send Tier 1, 2, and 3 PSPS updates as needed via the ACTNow application.

7. **Public Information & Notifications**

The PIO and/or the Communications Lead coordinate the following:

a. **72–48 hours before PSPS – PSPS Watch:**
   i. Publish the PSPS Watch web banner and update the PSE Alerts webpage: PSE | Alerts and advisories.
   ii. Share information via other channels (media, social media, etc.) as laid out in the PSPS Notification Execution Plan or determined by the Communications Lead.

b. **48 hours before PSPS – PSPS Warning:**
   i. Publish the PSPS Warning web banner and update the PSE Alerts webpage.
   ii. Notify Customer Care to make Life Support customer phone calls.
   iii. Publish PSPS Warning polygon on Outage Map.
   iv. Send PSPS Warning Customer Notification via the ACTNow application.
   v. Share information via other channels (media, social media, etc.) as laid out in the PSPS Notification Execution Plan or determined by the Communications Lead.

c. **48–4 hours before PSPS – Twice Daily Updates:**
   i. Send Customer Update Notifications (via the ACTNow application) twice daily until Imminent, per the PSPS Notification Execution Plan.
   ii. Share information via other channels (media, social media, etc.) as laid out in the PSPS Notification Execution Plan or determined by the Communications Lead.

d. **4 hours before PSPS – PSPS Imminent:**
   i. Publish PSPS Imminent web banner and update the PSE Alerts webpage.
   ii. Publish PSPS Imminent polygon on Outage Map.
   iii. Send PSPS Imminent Customer Notification via the ACTNow application.

e. **Shutoff – Restoration**
   i. Update the web banner and the PSE Alerts webpage before sending customer updates.
   ii. Send Customer Update Notifications (via the ACTNow application) twice daily until power is restored. Note: these updates are in addition to any automated notifications about the service they receive for outages.

8. **Ongoing Monitoring & Go/No-Go Decision**

a. The Operations Section Chief continues to monitor weather conditions (with support from the PSE Meteorologist and WLMs).

b. As conditions evolve, the Planning Section Chief initiates a planning call with the Operations Section Chief, PSPS ECC Director, PIO, Vice President of Gas & Electric Operations, and the Senior Vice President of Energy Operations to review readiness and timing.

9. Official Go/No-Go to move to PSPS – Level 4

a. **Go**: Operations coordinate initiation of PSPS – Level 4 per the approved IAP.

> **NOTE** An approximate 12-hour window will be required to stage resources and get from the Go decision to de-energization.

b. **No-Go**:

i. The PSPS ECC Director notifies all teams of the decision to de-escalate.

ii. The System Operations Supervisor coordinates returning to EPS – Level 2 or Routine Operations, per the IAP.

iii. Once the system has returned to EPS – Level 2 operations or lower, the PSPS ECC Director closes the ECC.

c. The Planning Section Chief ensures that all decisions are logged within the IAP to include the data below:

- Timestamp (PST)
- Approval authority (Senior Vice President, Vice President, and PSPS ECC Director) as applicable
- Criterion reference (specific trigger and threshold met per elevated Critical Fire Weather risk criteria)

d. The System Operations Supervisor maintains the Wildfire Critical Decision Tracker and applicable ADMS entries.

6.7.5 Initiate PSPS – Level 4

6.7.5.1 Initiation & Execution Procedures

When observations confirm that real-time weather conditions match forecasted weather parameters and fire risk data continues to indicate very active or extreme wildfire potential, the PSPS ECC Director activates PSPS plans per the approved IAP. The PIO and Communications Lead continue PSPS notifications per the PSPS Notification Execution Plan.

6.7.5.2 PSPS Initiation

1. The PSPS ECC Director provides an update, indicating advancement of PSPS plans to:

- Vice President of Gas & Electric Operations
- Vice President of Regulatory Affairs
- Senior Vice President of Energy Operations
- Washington State Department of Commerce
- Washington State Energy Resilience & EMD
- Washington UTC

- Operations Section Chief

2. The Operations Section Chief communicates advancement of PSPS plans to:
   - System Operations
   - Load Office
   - PIO
   - Communications Lead
   - Business Services Team
   - Substation Operations Duty
   - MLM Team
   - Impacted Regional **Unified Division Supervisor** (**UDS**)
   - **Targeted Notification Specialist** (**TNS**)
3. 12 hours before PSPS Initiation, the Operations Section Chief completes the following actions:
   a. Verify availability of field crews.
   b. Activate regional storm bases.
   c. Determine resource levels based on the size and scope of a potential PSPS.
   d. Notify line crews, Substation Inspectors, and Troublemen for potential response when additional resources are required beyond regional staffing.
   e. Place Troublemen and Substation Inspectors on shift to ensure 24/7 coverage.
   f. Conduct pre-PSPS meeting with operational leads to assign responsibilities and assess risks.
   g. Provide identified lead contacts to System Operations.
   h. Stage Troublemen and Substation Inspectors at impacted substations and transmission switches. System Operations and Load Office may bring in additional staff as needed.
   i. Send PSPS Imminent notifications.

6.7.5.3 Final Preparation Before De-Energization

1. As the initiation approaches, the Operations Section Chief confirms:
   - All assigned field crews are staged and ready
   - Regional storm bases are activated to include staffing a Dispatcher and Lead Operator
   - Customer communication plan is complete
2. Once readiness is confirmed, the Operations Section Chief notifies the following, and PSPS is authorized to commence:
   - ECC Staff
   - System Operations Supervisor
   - Load Office Supervisor
   - Substation Duty Supervisor
   - UDS

3. The following takes place for the execution of PSPS de-energization:
   a. The PSPS ECC Director confirms readiness and authorizes execution of the PSPS on impacted systems, per the approved IAP and the Go decision (see Section 6.7.4.3, Item 9).
   b. The System Operations Supervisor directs the FDSO to commence the distribution system de-energization plan, per the approved PSPS IAP.
   c. The FDSO coordinates opening the distribution circuit breakers, as documented in the PSPS IAP.
   d. The FDSO notifies the System Operations Supervisor once distribution devices for the PSPS are complete.
   e. The System Operations Supervisor notifies the Load Office Supervisor that distribution for the PSPS is complete and that transmission de-energization may begin.
   f. The Load Office Supervisor directs the Load Office to commence de-energization, if applicable.
   g. The Load Office/**Transmission Operator** (**TO**) de-energizes transmission lines, per the PSPS IAP.
      i. A dedicated TO may be assigned only to handle PSPS operations.
      ii. The TO logs all actions taken in iTOA.
      iii. The TO opens or directs the opening of the isolation devices, as identified in the PSPS IAP.
   h. The Load Office Supervisor notifies the System Operations Supervisor when the PSPS is complete.
   i. The System Operations Supervisor notifies the ECC that the PSPS is complete across distribution and transmission systems.
   j. The PIO issues the **PSPS Initiated** notification (power is off).
   k. The FDSO completes the following actions:
      i. Open, or direct the opening of, isolation devices in preparation for step restoration, beginning with the feeder-level three-phase (3Ø) getaway switch, then proceed sequentially.
      ii. Segment feeders as needed to support step restoration protocols.
      iii. Apply **Do Not Operate** (**DNO**) tags in the field.
      iv. Disable EPS on all PSPS circuits.

6.7.5.4 During the PSPS

1. Troublemen and field crews respond to emergencies (downed lines, safety hazards, and non-PSPS outages) as it is safe to do so.
2. The ECC Manager sends PSPS Situation Reports every 6 hours. The PIO determines internal and external messaging.
3. Troublemen and field crews report any system damage on the PSPS circuits (branches on lines, lines down, failed equipment) to the FDSO. The FDSO coordinates with field resources to isolate damage and reports the status to PSE base UDS leadership.

4. Restoration planning begins immediately:
    a. The ECC Operations Section develops a PSPS Recovery Plan and shares it with the PSPS ECC Director, ECC Team, System Operations, and Load Office.
    b. The System Operations Supervisor communicates field restoration activities.
    c. The FDSO prepares switching plans for patrol and step restoration.

6.7.5.5 PSPS Termination Criteria

The PSPS ECC Director – in coordination with the System Operations Supervisor, PSE Meteorologist, and WLMs – evaluates the following criteria before ending the PSPS:

- Forecasts and field observations indicate that the extreme weather event has passed
- Red Flag Warnings or Conditions have ended
- Observed wind gusts fall below triggering thresholds (via documented NWS observations and field reports)
- Input from fire agencies and EMR partners supports safe re-energization

6.7.5.6 PSPS Restoration

The Recovery Plan documents the specific circuits ready to energize and their associated restoration times. Once PSPS termination criteria are met, the Operations Section commences restoration efforts as outlined below:

1. The Operations Section develops a Recovery Plan that includes:
    a. Transmission line and distribution circuit restoration prioritization
    b. Transmission line and distribution circuit protection status upon completion
    c. Approximate date and time that restoration will begin
    d. Resource requirements and assignments by region and circuit/line
    e. ETR for each transmission line and distribution circuit
    f. PSE or patrolling response team(s) are assigned 12-hour shifts, as required
        i. Resource amounts are dependent upon the size and scope of a PSPS event and assets affected
2. The PSPS ECC Director provides **All Clear** Communications to the following:
    - Vice President of Gas & Electric Operations
    - Vice President of Regulatory Affairs
    - Senior Vice President of Energy Operations
    - Washington State Department of Commerce
    - Washington State Energy Resilience & Emergency Management Department
    - Washington State UTC
3. The Operations Section Chief provides Internal **All Clear** Communications to the following:
    - System Operations

- Load Office
- PIO
- Business Services Team
- Substation Operations Duty Supervisor
- MLM
- Impacted Regional UDS

4. The PIO provides **Weather All Clear** updates to external partners and issues the notifications to customers.
5. The Operations Section distributes the Recovery Plan to:
   - Regional Storm Base
   - UDS(s)
   - System Operations Supervisor
   - Load Office Supervisor
6. The FDSO completes the following actions:
   a. Assign Substation Inspectors and Troublemen to Transmission Patrol Teams for circuits and lines, as identified in the Recovery Plan.
   b. Document assignments in ADMS.
   c. Notify the TO of Patrol Team assignments.
7. The TO completes the following actions for transmission restoration:
   a. Log all actions in iTOA.
   b. Direct assigned Patrol Teams to begin transmission line patrols.
   c. Patrol and re-energize transmission segments in the order defined in the Recovery Plan.
8. Patrol transmission segments in their entirety before re-energization. If damage is identified during patrol:
   a. The Patrol Team notifies the TO.
   b. The TO isolates and tags affected equipment.
   c. The Patrol Team photographs damage and provides details to the UDS.
   d. The Regional Storm Bases coordinate system repairs.
   e. The repair crews take clearance on isolated sections, allowing the remaining sectionalized system to be restored.
   f. Upon completion of repairs and release of clearance, the TO requests a Patrol Team to re-patrol the repaired segment prior to re-energization, as required.
   g. The FDSO assigns a Patrol Team and notifies the TO of the resources assigned.
9. Prior to re-energization, the Patrol Team will:
   a. Receive the **All Clear** for each de-energized segment.

b. Close, or direct field resources to close, isolation device(s) for the cleared segment.

10. The TO notifies the FDSO of substations that have been energized.

> **NOTE** If significant damage results in extended transmission repair delays to a radial substation, suspend patrols of the associated distribution circuits until transmission restoration is imminent.

11. FDSO – Distribution Restoration:

    The FDSO restores the distribution system as follows:

    a. Direct Patrol Teams to begin distribution line patrols.
    b. Patrol and re-energize distribution circuits as defined in the Recovery Plan.
    c. Patrol distribution overhead primary lines in their entirety prior to re-energization.
    d. Perform step restoration in the following sequence:
        i. Substation circuit breaker
        ii. Getaway isolation
        iii. Open feeder isolation devices and continue sequentially until the entire circuit is restored
            1) Log an entry for each successfully cleared section, confirming that primary conductors and laterals are clear and in service.

12. If damage is identified during patrol, the Patrol Team notifies the FDSO.
    a. The FDSO creates an incident and orders equipment isolated and tagged.
    b. The Patrol Team photographs damage and provides details to the Regional Storm Base.
    c. The Regional Storm Bases coordinate system repairs.
    d. Repair crews take clearance on isolated sections, allowing the remaining sectionalized systems to be restored.
    e. Upon completion of repairs, the Crew Lead patrols the isolated section for additional damage.
    f. Once repairs are complete, lines are verified up and in the clear, and clearance is released, the FDSO directs the Crew Lead to re-energize.

13. Restoration Completion Notifications:
    a. The FDSO notifies the System Operations Supervisor that restoration is complete.
    b. The System Operations Supervisor notifies the ECC that restoration is complete.
    c. The PSPS ECC Director closes the ECC and returns to Routine Operations status.

7 Documentation & Records

All actions, decisions, and operational changes must be documented in their designated systems.

7.1 Logging Requirements

All escalation, de-escalation, and operational actions must be documented in an ICS 214 Activity Log, including timestamps, approval authority, and a record of critical conversations and actions executed.

7.2 Required Records and Record Storage

Records are stored in system databases, ECC documentation repositories, and wildfire management systems.

NOTE Retention periods are governed by PSE's Records and Information Management Policy.

Table 7: Required Records and Record Storage

Record	Owner	Storage Location/System
ADMS Event Incident Log	System Operations Supervisor/FDSO	ADMS
EPS Fault Occurrence Notification Records (per MOU with DNR)	Load Office Supervisor and System Operations Supervisor	System log/ECC documentation repository
iTOA Log (transmission actions)	Load Office/Transmission Operator	iTOA
PSPS IAP	Planning Section Chief	ECC documentation repository
PSPS Notification Execution Plan	PIO/Communications Lead	ECC documentation repository
PSPS Recovery Plan	Operations Section Chief	ECC documentation repository
Operational Action Recommendation Template	System Operations Supervisor	ECC Wildfire Mitigation folder
PSPS Situation Report	ECC Manager	ECC documentation repository
System Log	System Operations Supervisor	ADMS/iTOA
Wildfire Critical Decision Tracker	System Operations Supervisor	ECC Wildfire Mitigation folder
ICS 214 Activity Log	All ECC roles (per assigned function)	ECC documentation repository

8 References

The following references support this procedure and are used for operational execution, situational awareness, and decision-making.

8.1 Contact Information and Support Phone Numbers

NOTE Phone numbers have been removed from this work sample.

Table 8: Contact Information and Support Phone Numbers

Contact	Phone Number
NWS Seattle/Tacoma Office	(xxx) xxx-xxxx

Contact	Phone Number
NWS Spokane Office	(xxx) xxx-xxxx
NWS Pendleton Office	(xxx) xxx-xxxx
Washington State EMD	(xxx) xxx-xxxx
Washington Utilities and Transportation Commission	(xxx) xxx-xxxx
WWG	(xxx) xxx-xxxx
24-hour On-Call WLM	(xxx) xxx-xxxx
24-hour Public Info Hotline	(xxx) xxx-xxxx

8.2 Tools, Systems, and Platforms

- ADMS
- iTOA
- Technosylva FireRisk
- Wildfire Critical Decision Tracker

8.3 Procedures, Forms, and Templates

- ICS 214 Activity Log
- OAR (completed form)
- Operational Action Recommendation Template
- PSE Wildfire Season Declaration Procedure
- PSPS IAP
- PSPS Notification Execution Plan
- Records and Information Management Policy

8.4 Internal Documents

- Fire Weather – Red Flag Notification List
- PSE Employee Safety and Health Programs
- PSE Wildfire Situation Briefing
- Wind Gust Limits – 2026 Fire Season Spreadsheet

8.5 Web Resources and External-Facing Platforms

- ACTNow application
- NWS Washington Fire Weather Zones Map
- Pacific Northwest 7-Day Significant Fire Potential Outlook
- PSE | Alerts and advisories

Appendix A – Technosylva FireRisk

PSE uses the Technosylva FireRisk platform to model Critical Fire Weather conditions, predict potential system impacts, and support operational decision-making during elevated and Critical Fire Weather periods. FireRisk analyzes a range of variables, including infrastructure damage potential, weather forecasts, fuel conditions, and terrain to calculate multiple fire behavior and electrical system risk indices.

FireRisk performs ignition simulations every 100 meters across all utility transmission and distribution assets, and calculates an FBI for each simulation. This model updates daily based on the 24-hour weather forecast, and risk is calculated at 3-hour intervals across the entire forecast period. Asset-level risk can be viewed for every interval, providing a clear visual representation on the FireRisk map of which assets are at highest risk at any given point in time. PSE uses this tool to assess expected infrastructure asset risk, expected fire spread if an ignition occurs, and circuits with an elevated **Probability of Failure (PoF)**. In November 2025, PSE updated the weather and fuels modeling to incorporate the following data sources:

- **Weather Research and Forecasting** (**WRF**) Historical Re-Analysis Weather Data (20-year data set)
- WRF Daily Weather Operational Data
- Technosylva Surface and Canopy Fuels Data

The daily FireRisk analysis generates a dashboard used by System Operations and the ECC to evaluate system risk and take informed operational actions. Additional details can be found in the application's Knowledge Base. The following list summarizes several of the core FireRisk outputs used in this procedure:

- **FPIC**: A fire danger metric that reflects environmental conditions associated with catastrophic powerline fires.
  - Supports short-term (daily) evaluation of fire potential
  - Helps utilities make risk-informed operational decisions
- **FBI**: Represents expected fire behavior and suppression difficulty if a fire occurs.
  - Values range from 1 (low) to 5 (extreme)
  - Based on the first 8 hours of fire growth without suppression
  - Derived from a simulated flame length and **Rate of Spread** (**ROS**)
  - Updated every 3 hours based on forecasted weather and fuel conditions
  - Incorporates temperature, wind speed, relative humidity, and dead fuel moisture
- **FSP**: Represents the potential acreage that a fire could reach within 8 hours if the initial attack is unsuccessful.
  - Based on local fuels, weather, and terrain
  - Provided in acres
- **PoF**: Represents the daily probability of a wind-related outage on a circuit.
  - Indicates the likelihood of at least one sustained outage within a 24-hour period

- Derived from historical weather data, historical outages, and asset characteristics
- Highlights circuits with elevated outage probability during wind events

Appendix B – Incident Management Team

During a PSPS event, a selection of standard ECC positions is staffed along with specific PSPS IMT roles that are not part of the standard ECC structure. These specific roles are highlighted in Figure 1 below. See Section 6.7.4.3, Item 2 for the standard IMT roles that are required 72 hours and 48 hours prior to PSPS.

In scenarios involving overlapping emergency responses, such as a widespread electric outage or natural gas event, the PSPS ECC Director may choose to activate the standard ECC Operations and Planning Sections to manage the broader emergency. In these cases, the PSPS IMT functions will continue to focus specifically on PSPS-related responsibilities and decision-making. If a specific position is unavailable, a qualified designee may assume the role as necessary. To determine who is on the PSPS IMT, refer to the Weekly Emergency Duty Rotation email.

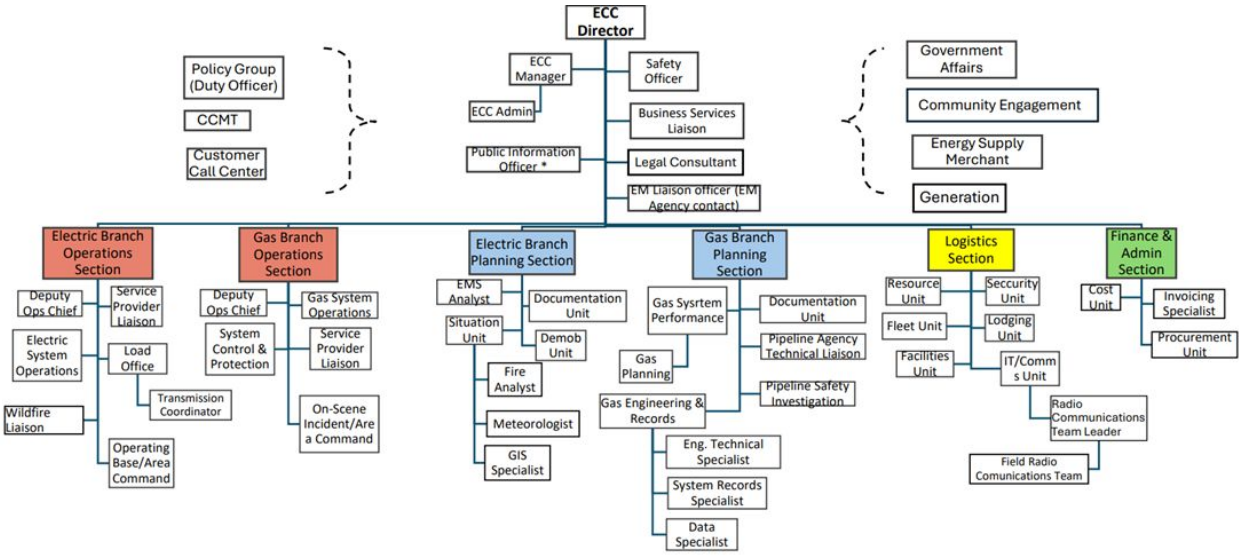


Figure 1: ECC Organization Chart

Appendix C – PSPS Operations Timeline Overview

Figure 2 below provides a high-level visual overview of the operational actions, communications, and escalation decisions associated with Operational Levels 2–4, organized by timeframe from 72 to 4 hours before a potential PSPS.

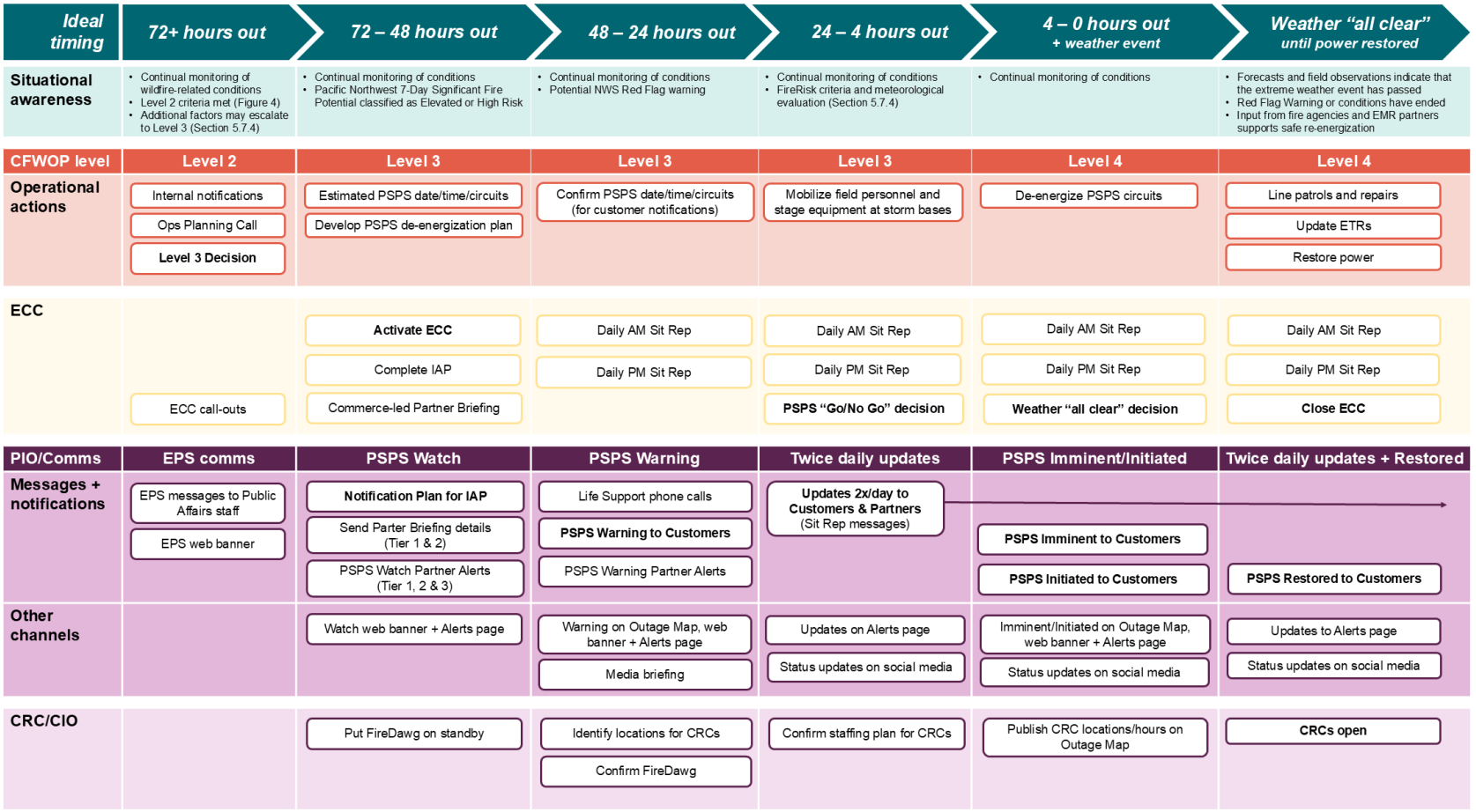


Figure 2: PSPS Operations Timeline Overview

Appendix D – Level 2 Escalation Checklist

NOTE The Level 2 Escalation Checklist is a mandatory requirement to be completed by the System Operations Supervisor.

***Prerequisite**: Level 2 escalation must be approved by the Director of Electric System Control (or designee) before initiating any step below. Log the approval in the Wildfire Critical Decision Tracker before closing this checklist.*

Table 9: Level 2 Escalation Checklist

Step	Phase	Action	Responsible Role	Notes	✔
PHASE 1 – Internal Communications & Notifications					
1	*Notifications*	Coordinate all internal communications for Level 2 escalation.	System Operations Supervisor		☐
1a	*Notifications*	Send an email to the Fire Weather – Red Flag Notification List containing a summary of the Operations Planning Call, confirming escalation to Level 2.	System Operations Supervisor	*Dist. list: Appendix C*	☐
1b	*Notifications*	Post an update in the ECC Team's General Channel.	System Operations Supervisor	*ECC Teams channel*	☐
1b-i	*Notifications*	Tag "Fire Weather Comms" in the post. This initiates: (1) updating the PSE web banner, and (2) distributing external talking points to community affairs, government affairs, and the call center.	System Operations Supervisor	*Wildfire Comms Team is tagged recipient*	☐
1b-ii	*Notifications*	If after business hours, call the 24-hour Public Info Hotline.	System Operations Supervisor		☐
1c	*Notifications*	Contact interconnected customers and utilities by phone, as defined in the OAR, to advise that EPS activation may affect their operations.	System Operations Supervisor	*Refer to current OAR*	☐
1d	*Notifications*	Send an email to the "Fire Weather Event Response" list including: (1) forecast timing, (2) escalation event details, (3) when settings must be in place, (4) expected return-to-normal time, and (5) a staffing table for System Operations and field personnel.	System Operations Supervisor	*"Fire Weather Event Response" list*	☐

Step	Phase	Action	Responsible Role	Notes	✔
PHASE 2 – Regional Lead Operator Activation					
2	Activation	Provide the Regional Lead Operator with the list of impacted circuits and associated substations identified for Level 2 settings activation, including all applicable EPS-capable circuits and any non-EPS-Capable circuits requiring alternative operational strategies (block reclosing and/or hot line work switch).	System Operations Supervisor		☐
2a	*Activation*	Establish incidents in ADMS to track fire-danger actions, beginning with the event incident. Transfer incident management to the FDSO upon completion and remain available to assist as needed.	Regional Lead Operator		☐
PHASE 3 – FDSO Staffing					
3	*FDSO Staffing*	Staff an FDSO for the full duration of the event.	System Operations Supervisor		☐
3a	*FDSO Staffing*	Initiate FDSO callout immediately upon Level 2 approval.	System Operations Supervisor		☐
3b	*FDSO Staffing*	If immediate FDSO coverage is needed, assign the most qualified on-shift operator to temporarily fill the role until relief arrives.	System Operations Supervisor		☐
3b-i	*FDSO Staffing*	Assign remaining on-shift operators to cover any resulting vacant region.	System Operations Supervisor		☐
PHASE 4 – Storm Mode Activation					
4	*Storm Mode Activation*	Enable Storm Mode in the ADMS for distribution circuits and substations designated for EPS action up to an hour before initiation. Use storm reason: **FD <Region> MM/DD/YYYY.**	System Operations Supervisor		☐
PHASE 5 – EPS Activation					
5	*EPS Activation*	Stand by and confirm completion of each action before proceeding to logging.	System Operations Supervisor		☐

Step	Phase	Action	Responsible Role	Notes	✔
5a	*EPS Activation*	Coordinate with field resources to enable EPS on all designated assets. For assets without EPS capability, disable reclosing and enable the hot line work switch. Notify the System Operations Supervisor when all assets are complete.	FDSO		☐
5b	*EPS Activation*	Evaluate all designated transmission line segments and take the following actions, then notify the System Operations Supervisor upon completion.	Load Office Supervisor/Power Dispatcher		☐
5c	*EPS Activation*	Disable reclosing on identified high-risk transmission lines, if not already disabled due to PSE Wildfire Season.	Load Office Supervisor/Power Dispatcher		☐
5c-i	*EPS Activation*	De-energize identified transmission line segments, if not already de-energized due to PSE Wildfire Season.	Load Office Supervisor/Power Dispatcher		☐
5c-ii	*EPS Activation*	Log the status of all reclosing actions and transmission line segment changes in iTOA.	Load Office Supervisor/Power Dispatcher	*iTOA required*	☐
PHASE 6 – Required Logging & Documentation					
6	*Logging*	Complete all required logging to ensure full traceability of Level 2 actions.	System Operations Supervisor		☐
6a	*Logging*	Log the escalation in the Wildfire Critical Decision Tracker. Include: (1) time-stamped approving authority, and (2) the applicable criterion reference.	System Operations Supervisor	*Wildfire Critical Decision Tracker*	☐
6b	*Logging*	Log confirmation in the event incident in ADMS that EPS has been enabled on all desired circuits and all Level 2 actions are complete.	System Operations Supervisor	*Event incident in ADMS*	☐
6c	*Logging*	Respond to the “Fire Weather Event Response” email list using Reply All to confirm that all actions have been taken and EPS is enabled.	System Operations Supervisor	*Reply All required*	☐

Appendix E – Emergency Contacts

Table 10: Wildfire Response Agencies

Wildfire Response Agencies	Contact Information
CWICC Dispatch	(509) 884-3473 (business) (509) 884-3474 (emergency)
DNR Pacific Cascade Region Dispatch	(360) 575-5089
DNR Northwest Region Dispatch	(360) 854-2878
DNR South Puget Sound Region Dispatch	(360) 802-7080
KittCom – Kittitas County 911 Dispatch	(509) 925-8534 (business) (509) 925-9811 (emergency)

Table 11: Emergency Management

Emergency Management	Contact Information
Island County	(360) 679-9567
King County	(206) 423-6119
Kitsap County	(360) 307-5910
Kittitas County	(509) 928-8534
Lewis County	(360) 740-1105
Pierce County	(253) 798-7470
Skagit County	(360) 428-3211
Snohomish County	(425) 320-9189
Thurston County	(360) 704-2740
Washington State Department of Commerce, Energy Resilience & Emergency Management Division	(360) 725-2866 wa.energyem@commerce.wa.gov
Washington State EMD Duty Desk	1-800-258-5990
Whatcom County	(360) 676-6814

Appendix F – Revision History

Table 12: Revision History

Revision Date	Revision Number	Summary of Changes	Changes Made By
06-03-2025	01	Document and process update	C. DeCamillo
06-06-2025	01	Updated all references of FPI2.0 to FPIC throughout the document Provided links directly to OAR and IAP throughout the document	C. DeCamillo
06-11-2025	01	Updated Level 2 trigger thresholds and Level 2 Ops Planning Call	C. DeCamillo
07-01-2025	01	Updated IMT to include planning section, as well as procedural changes to include the Planning Section Chief	C. DeCamillo
07-02-2025	01	Updates to Level 2 Ops Planning Call, Level 3+ criteria, and Level 2+ Operational Modifications (delayed restoration)	C. DeCamillo
07-10-2025	01	Updates to System Supervisor responsibilities around communication to interconnected customers	C. DeCamillo
03-12-2026	01	Updated document processes	G. Ahearn
07-08-2026	02	Updated document processes	G. Ahearn
08-19-2026	03	Updated EPS Level 2 processes	D. Porter